



FILM INDUSTRY

New Zealand has a well-established film industry. Today, thanks to the acclaimed films based on J.R.R. Tolkien's trilogy *The Lord of the Rings* (above) and *The Hobbit*, the country has become increasingly popular with international studios for location work. The country offers an unusually wide range of scenery as well as technical experts.



AN AGRICULTURAL NATION

Agriculture is of prime importance, and accounts for more than half of national export earnings. Orchards produce a vast range of fruit from apples (above) to kiwi fruit (below). Cereals and other crops, such as sunflowers, add color and variety to the landscape. Traditional sheep and cattle farming has expanded to include deer, goats, and even ostriches.



Lady Knox geyser, North Island

UNIQUE WILDLIFE
New Zealand has many unique and endangered animal species, especially birds. There were no mammal predators before humans introduced them, so many animal species have few means of defense, and some birds such as the kiwi cannot fly. Conservation schemes are now in place to protect endangered species.

Flightless Kiwi bird

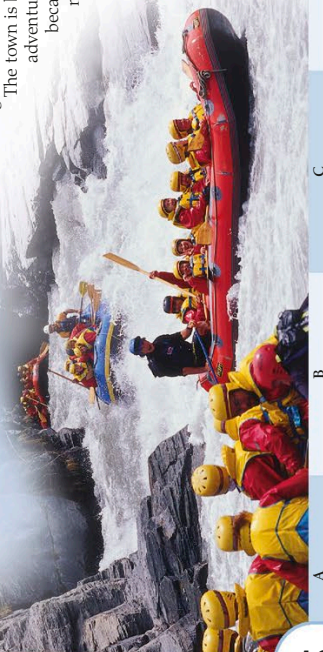
GREEN ENERGY
Most of the country's electricity comes from hydroelectric power. It is generated by river water gushing through turbines inside dams at power stations. New Zealand also has geothermal energy, using heat from inside Earth.



ADVENTURE SPORTS PARADISE

New Zealand offers a huge range of adventure sports and outdoor activities, from white-water rafting (below) to bungee jumping. The latter originated in Queenstown on South Island.

The town is billed as the country's top adventure tourism destination because its surrounding lakes, mountains, and rivers, and its mostly dry climate, are ideal for outdoor pursuits.



VOCANIC ACTIVITY

A fault line runs through New Zealand, where two major tectonic plates meet. It has caused devastating earthquakes, but has also helped to create breathtaking scenery. This includes South Island's Southern Alps, and many smaller volcanic mountains, hot springs, and geysers on North Island.

